प्रधानआयुक्त सीमा शुल्क)आयात(का कार्यालय
OFFICE OF THE PR. COMMISSIONER OF CUSTOMS (IMPORT),
तकनीकी अनुभाग, हवाई माल संकुल सहार, अंधेरी)पूर्व(, मुंबई- ४०० ०९९
TECHNICAL CELL, AIR CARGO COMPLEX, SAHAR,
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Date - 22.07.2025

Minutes of the Permanent Trade Facilitation Committee meeting held on 14-07-2025

The Monthly meeting of Permanent Trade Facilitation Committee (PTFC), for the month of July 2025, was held in the Conference Hall of ACC at 03:00 PM on 14.07.2025 and was chaired by Shri Manish Chandra, Principal Commissioner of Customs (Import), co-chaired by Shri Hardeep Batra, Commissioner of Customs (Export). The following officers and representatives participated in the meeting:

S.No.	Name & Designation	Organization
1	Shri Tagadi Manjunath Addl. Commissioner of Customs (Import)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
2	Shri Vijay J Manvatkar, Addl. Commissioner of Customs (Export)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
3	Shri N. Pandiyaraj, Joint Commissioner of Customs (Import)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
4	Shri Prakash Chaudhary, Joint Commissioner of Customs (Import)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
5	Smt Priya Jadhav Joint Commissioner of Customs (General)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
6	Smt. DaribhaLyndem Joint Commissioner of Customs (Export)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
7	Kanhaiya Poddar Deputy Commissioner of Customs	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
8	Jai Singh Rathore Assistant Commissioner of Customs	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
9	Shri Rajesh Ramlal Solanki, Assistant Commissioner of Customs	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
10	Shri M. Sree Harsha, Assistant Commissioner of Customs	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
11	Shri K. Poddar, Assistant Commissioner of Customs	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
12	Shri.Gautam Shilare Assistant Commissioner of Customs	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
13	Smt. Jolly Kashy Assistant Commissioner of Customs	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
14	Smt. Kiran Vaidya Assistant Commissioner of Customs	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
15	I Ramalingeshwara Rao Assistant Commissioner of	Customs, ACC,

	Customs	Mumbai
16	M Sree Harsha Assistant Commissioner of Customs	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
17	Manisha S Jadhav Superintendent of Customs	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
18	Shri Narendra Kannaujia, Superintendant of Customs	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
19	Shri Narendra Pathak, Appraiser	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
20	Shri Etteari Himagiri, Examiner	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
21	Shri Mohit, Preventive officer	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
22	Shri Pawan Kumar Superintendent of Customs	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
23	Shri Hiren Joshi	AIASL
24	Shri Amey Pawar, Manager	Newgen Software Tech Ltd
25	VP. Salonki	AIASL
26	Shri Sanjay P. , Manager	EK
27	Shri Robin Fernandes	CX
28	Shri Kaushal Thakker , Chairman Import	BCBA
29	Shri Paresh Sangari, Chairman PGA	BCBA
30	Shri Ketan Desai, Treasurer	BCBA
31	Shri Sanjeev Harale, President	BCBA
32	Shri Farokh Hansotia	ACAAI
33	Shri Dushyant Mulani, Chairman	FFFAI
34	Shri Gaurav, Associate Manager	MIAL
35	Shri Amit Kadam, Associate Manager	MIAL
36	Shri Bhagodia Vijay, Assistant General Manager	MIAL
37	Shri. Jayachandra. A	CSC
38	Shri Gokul Ram, Plant Protection Officer, Entomology	PQ
39	Shri Prashant Popat	AMTOI
40	Dr. Vignesh. V	AQCS, Mumbai

Representatives of WCCB, FSSAI and CDSCO did not attend the meeting.

The Principal Commissioner of Customs (Import) welcomed all the attendees. The following agenda points were taken up:

1. Monsoon Preparedness at Air India Shed:

BCBA raised the issue that during the monsoon season, persistent roof leakages and water logging issues have been observed at the Air India Shed, causing damage to consignments. BCBA requested information regarding the

precautionary measures and the monsoon preparedness plan to address this recurring issue.

Discussions and decisions:

The representative of the AIASL informed that they have taken the following steps to effectively handle the monsoon situation in the Air India Shed.

a. Temporary Monsoon Shed Repairs:

A vendor has been appointed for the Temporary Monsoon Shed. Approximately 90% of the repair work has been successfully completed at the Import Shed. The vendor will now proceed to the ETV building to carry out the remaining work related to the Monsoon Shed. Additionally, to ensure effective drainage of rainwater, the roof gutter outlets and adjacent pits have been thoroughly cleaned to prevent water logging.

b. Permanent Repairs – Vendor Appointment:

The process of appointing a separate vendor for Permanent Shed and roof gutter repairs has been completed. The shortlisted vendor is currently in the process of obtaining the necessary permissions to begin the work.

c. Ongoing Monsoon Preparedness:

AIASL confirms that monsoon preparedness activities are actively underway, with a priority focus on resolving leakage and water logging issues before further escalation.

The Chair has decided to close the point.

(Point Closed)
(Action: AIASL)

2. Stoppage of Freighter Operation w.e.f. 16 August 2025 due to runway maintenance:

The Custodian, i.e. MIAL has issued an Advisory dated 21.04.2025 to the trade regarding upgradation of infrastructure resulting in stoppage of Freighter operations w.e.f. 16.08.2025. The same was strongly opposed by IATA on 29.04.2025 urging MIAL to reconsider the decision. The reduction in Air Cargo Capacity will impact inbound and out bound cargo and may lead to inflated freight rates, potentially giving an opportunity for other locations to shift the traditional cargo out of ACC, Mumbai like Pharmaceuticals and Chemicals which are the major commodity handled from Mumbai Airport. Such maintenance/ upgradation activity has been conducted in the past as well without any reduction in cargo capacity out of Mumbai.

Discussion and decision:

The MIAL has informed that the Slot Management Team of AOCC (Airport Operations Control Centre) directly informs the Airlines regarding the availability of

all slots. MIAL has further informed that Airlines are able to book their slots well in advance without any difficulty, and no operational issues are being reported at present. The Chair has decided to close the point.

(**Point Closed)**

3. Assessment of Shipping Bills (SBs) at ACC Mumbai

BCBA has raised a point that Shipping Bills are not being assessed unless Custom Brokers (CBs) physically visit the Appraising Officers, despite all necessary documents being uploaded via E-Sanchit. Given that the EDI system is designed for faceless processing, such physical follow-up should not be necessary. Additionally, they pointed out that even after assessment, "open and examine" instructions are frequently issued. Since most shipments at ACC Mumbai involve Pharmaceuticals and Chemicals, unnecessary package opening may lead to contamination risks. They urged that such orders be limited strictly to cases where sampling is genuinely required.

Discussion and decision:

The Commissioner (Export) informed that there is no need to attend/entertain any verbal queries raised by Appraising Officers and all the queries/ instructions are to be followed only after proper communication from the dealing officer. If any difficulties are faced during the clearance process, the concerned CB/Exporter may approach the higher authorities for quicker resolution. The Commissioner (Export) also informed that whenever there are instructions from the System for “open and examine” then the same cannot be ignored and waiver for open and examination will only be processed on case to case basis and on merits if necessary. The Chair has decided to close the point.

(Point: Closed)

4. Appointment of Dedicated Officers for AEO Clients:

As per the CBIC Circular No. 33/2016, specific officers should be designated for the facilitation and expedited clearance of AEO client consignments. To enhance efficiency, BCBA requested to appoint dedicated officers at both the assessment and examination stages to support timely processing for AEO-status importers.

Discussion and decision:

The Chair informed that priority to AEO Client’s consignments is accorded by the System itself. Also, there is no pendency in the clearance of the cargo in the Import Shed. The Chair informed the trade bodies that if there are any specific instances where delays regarding AEO Clients has occurred, such details may be furnished so as to verify the reasons and take corrective steps to reduce the dwell time. No AEO has represented so far regarding any delays faced. The Chair decided to close this point.

(**Point Closed)**

5. Delays in Clearance of Fabric Items under Certain Tariff Heading:

BCBA informed that clearance of fabric consignments classified under Headings 61, 62, 63, and 64 is being delayed due to unnecessary requirements for NOC from Additional/Joint Commissioners of Import Shed for waiver of withdrawal of RSS for Testing. They further informed that it was occurring despite the fact that the Bills of Entry (BoE), guided by RMS and non-RMS systems, already reflect exemptions from AZO dye testing as per the country of origin. In accordance with DGFT Public Notice No. 10/2015-2020 dated 18.05.2016, imports from countries like the EU, Serbia, Poland, Denmark, China, Australia, Canada, Japan, and South Korea are exempt. It is requested that Shed Officers be authorized to issue Out of Charge (OOC) based on these existing instructions, without referring cases to higher authorities unnecessarily.

Discussion and decision:

The point raised by the BCBA was noted and the Chair informed that unnecessary RSS withdrawal for testing and waiver of RSS Testing from Additional/Joint Commissioners (Import Shed) is not to be done. The RSS Testing is conducted as per the System/RMS/Target instructions and DGFT PN 14/2023 dated 14.06.2023 wherever applicable. However, the Chair instructed the Deputy/Assistant Commissioners (DC/AC) of the Import Shed to closely monitor such cases and prevent delays by adhering to applicable exemptions and system-generated instructions, without referring such cases to higher authorities unless specifically required. The Chair has decided to close the point.

(Point Closed)

6. Delays in AQ System Processing:

BCBA has submitted the following points with respect to the consignments involving AQ NOC.

a. The current AQ system requires document submission both via email and physically at the Koparkhairne office. However, processing often takes 2–3 days, with documents submitted in the morning typically addressed only after 6:00 PM. Any follow-up queries are emailed the next day, adding to delays and transaction costs. They requested for a streamlined and digitized process for faster turnaround and reduced dwell time.

b. Delay is happening while taking NOC from AQ (PGA) for Bill of Entry. There are few issues with AQ like, AQ authority raising the query by sending e-mail to CB, they requested that such queries be raised via their portal for the sake of transparency, and the importer also receives such notification of the query.

c. The AQ authority is asking for the BoE copy along with IGM details, The trade is filing the BoE in advance and in such cases the AQ authority is raising the

query to submit the BoE copy with IGM details. BCBA requested the AQ authority to avoid asking the details of IGM as this is delaying the clearance and the BoE with IGM may not be available till the OOC print is received by the CB.

Discussion and decision:

1. With respect to the query sent via email instead of Portal, the AQ Officer informed that login access to raise queries and issue NOC's through their online portal has been given to only one officer (Group A) in their Koparkhairne office. The Login module being sensitive the credentials are not shared with any officer in their office. Hence, the other officers raise the queries in email to the Importers. Subsequently, the Supervisory Officer issues NOC's in one go after 6PM to all the consignments which fulfil the criteria.

2. AQ Officer further informed that the advance NOC is not possible for majority consignments in view of nature and sensitivity involved for Livestock Products. Hence BE with IGM is asked.

3. The Chair instructed the AQ representative to raise the queries and issue the NOC's regularly throughout the day to which AQ representative said that these will be done in 3 time slots in the day at 2PM, 4PM, 6PM. The Chair also said to raise the queries from the AQ module itself instead of emails, for transparency. The Chair also advised the AQ representative not to insist on submission of the Bill of Entry (BoE) along with the Import General Manifest (IGM). The AQ representative concurred and assured that the practice would be discontinued. The Chair pointed out that PGA's make up 10% of all BE's but certain PGA's like AQ and PQ are taking as much as 8-9 days for their NOC's which is significantly increasing the overall Dwell Time of ACC. The Chair has decided to close the point.

(Point : Closed)
(Action : Animal Quarantine)

7. Automatic Flagging of Goods Under Chapters 29 and 30 :

BCBA proposed automatic flagging of goods under Chapters 29 and 30 in the FAG system. These Chapters cover hazardous and life-saving pharmaceutical products that require prioritized handling. Flagging these consignments will help ensure timely and appropriate assessment. They requested to forward this proposal to DG Systems for implementation.

Discussion and decision:

The Chair has informed BCBA to give a detailed representation with list of Tariff Lines and examples of Bills of Entry for the matter to be taken up with the DG Systems. The Chair has decided to close this point.

(Point Closed)
(Action: BCBA)

8. Request to Extend Entry Permit Pass Validity to 60 Days Due to Inoperative Online System :

BCBA informed that the Entry Permit Passes are being issued for a maximum of 25 days by MIAL. Trade Members have to go for renewal of their Entry Permit Passes frequently. This is because the MIAL Security's online facility to apply for passes has been non-functional for the last six months. They requested MIAL to arrange for their Online Entry Permit System to start as early as possible, which has remained down for the unusually long period of more than six months. In these circumstances, they also requested to issue passes for 60 days instead of 25 days.

Discussion and decision:

MIAL informed that the Cargo Entry Permit (CEP) application system has been under maintenance and upgrade since 29th April, 2025. Additionally, the Daily Entry Permit system has been operational since 19th June 2025. MIAL also informed that they are targeting a full go-live of the upgraded CEP system by 19th July 2025, post which they will resume the facilitation of issue of Permanent Passes. The Chair has decided to close the point.

(Point Closed)
Action: MIAL

9. Non-presentation of goods for examination by the Trade/Importers:

Apart from the increase in the Dwell Time because of PGA NOC's, non-presentation of goods for examination by the respective Importer/Custom Brokers in the Import Shed is causing delays in clearance and thereby increasing overall Dwell Time.

Discussion and decision:

Trade informed that NOC requirements from PGA's is added in Assessment instructions(Non Swift cases) which generally reflects only after registration of the PGA linked BoE thereby increasing the time to present the goods for examination. However the Chair informed that in other cases also the goods are not being presented for examination even after registration. They are presented late. The Chair instructed the Trade not to delay the presentation of the goods for examination as this adds up to the Dwell Time. Customs will send back all such BE's to the importer if the goods are not presented for examination within reasonable period after registration. Daily lists of such cases will be displayed in Notice Board and Digital Display Board for CBs and Importers to take necessary action. MIAL was requested to provide Digital Display Boards accordingly.

(Action : Trade Bodies)

10. Issues faced in NAC Sectoral Meetings in Faceless assessment

BCBA and all the Trade bodies were informed by the Chair to communicate any problems faced by them in Faceless Assessment pertaining to NAC Sectoral meetings.

Discussion and decision:

The Chair advised the Trade Bodies to participate in NAC Sectoral meetings with major Importers to learn about the real time issues faced by them in Faceless Assessment and for resolutions. Trade Bodies and top Importers will be invited in PTFC meetings in the future.

(Action: Trade Bodies)

Pr. Commissioner informed that in the recently conducted Time Release Study (TRS) at all India level, Mumbai ACC was found to be having a longer Dwell Time of 45:08 hrs. compared to the National average of 39:20 hrs. for major ACC's. This should serve as a critical indicator and all stakeholders-MIAL, PGA's, Custom Brokers, Importers have to take corrective action in line with the best practices. MIAL in particular has to upgrade infrastructure and PGA's take steps to reduce their Dwell Time.

The meeting ended with a vote of thanks to the Chair and all attendees.

This issues with the approval of the Principal Commissioner of Customs, Import, ACC, Mumbai – III.

Digitally signed by
Tagadi Manjunath
Date: 22-07-2025
17:10:16

(TAGADI MANJUNATH)
Additional Commissioner of Customs,
Import Commissionerate, ACC, Mumbai - III

Copy to:-

1. Addl. Commissioner of Customs, O/o Pr. Chief Commissioner of Customs, Mumbai - III.
2. Pr. Commissioner/ Commissioner of Customs, Import/Export/General, ACC.
3. All Addl./JC Commissioner of Customs, Import/Export/General, ACC.
4. All member of PTFC meeting including BCBA & ACAAI (via e-mail).
5. DC/EDI for uploading on ACC website (via e-mail).
6. PGAs, ACC Mumbai (via e-mail).
7. Office copy.